College Algebra Skills Hub Strategic Plan Alignment

Connections to the Lone Star College System Strategic Plan 2025 to 2030

Overall Alignment

The College Algebra Skills Hub aligns most directly with G2 Leading in Academic Excellence. The project combines instruction with targeted student support, which is the central purpose of G2, and is designed to improve access to explanations, practice, and guided help for students with different levels of preparation. It also supports the System mission by helping students move from their current level of mathematical preparation toward successful completion of College Algebra and later academic goals.

The Hub also makes a meaningful but less direct contribution to G4 Connections to Bridges of Prosperity because College Algebra is an important gateway for many transfer pathways and degree programs. Faculty and tutoring collaboration provide a secondary connection to G3 Culture and Talent Development. G1 Opportunity in Financial Resilience is not a primary alignment; any efficiency created through shared, reusable materials would be an operational benefit rather than evidence that the project fulfills G1.

Strategic element	Level of alignment	Connection to the Hub
System vision and mission	Direct support	Provides accessible educational support that helps students progress from current preparation toward academic goals
G2 Academic Excellence	Strong and direct	Combines high-quality instruction with targeted support intended to improve learning and course progress
G4 Bridges of Prosperity	Meaningful contribution	Strengthens preparation for transfer and degree pathways that depend on successful completion of gateway mathematics
G3 Culture and Talent Development	Secondary support	Encourages communication, shared development, and instructional innovation among faculty and tutoring staff
G1 Financial Resilience	Limited connection	May reduce duplicated effort through reusable resources, but does not directly address the employee-centered outcomes of G1

Strongest Alignment With G2 Academic Excellence

G2 calls for academic excellence through the combination of high-quality instruction and support that improves learning, completion, transfer, and career outcomes. The Skills Hub is designed around that same combination. It would not replace classroom teaching or assigned coursework. It would extend instruction by giving students a reliable place to review missing prerequisite skills, revisit a current topic, practice independently, or work through a guided explanation.

- **High-quality instruction:** Resources can be aligned with local course expectations, notation, and teaching methods rather than relying entirely on generic materials.

- **Layered academic support:** Students can choose a short animation, reference material, independent practice, guided practice, or a full tutorial according to the level of help they need.
- **Support beyond the classroom:** D2L, the Math Portal, and tutoring referrals can connect classroom instruction with support available outside scheduled class time.
- **Learning improvement:** Practice results, common errors, and student feedback can identify where students are struggling and where resources should be revised.
- **Completion and transfer contribution:** Stronger support in a gateway course may contribute to persistence and transfer readiness, although those longer-term effects would need to be evaluated rather than assumed.

This alignment is especially strong because the strategic plan describes student success as a collective responsibility shared by classroom instruction and support services. The Hub would give instructors and tutors a common resource for directing students to targeted help while keeping the instructional connection to the course visible.

Contribution to G4 Bridges of Prosperity

G4 focuses on connecting students to successful transfer and gainful employment. The Skills Hub would not provide employment placement or transfer advising, so it should not be presented as a direct G4 initiative. Its contribution is earlier in the pathway: helping students build the mathematical foundation needed to progress through College Algebra and into programs that lead to transfer, credentials, or careers.

This is a meaningful connection because the strategic plan emphasizes preparing students to succeed after they leave Lone Star College rather than lowering academic expectations. The Hub supports that approach by maintaining the academic standard while providing more ways for students to reach it. Its strongest G4 relevance would be demonstrated through improved preparation for later coursework and successful movement through transfer-oriented degree pathways.

Secondary Connection to G3 Culture and Talent Development

G3 emphasizes communication, engagement, and innovation among employees. The Hub could support those conditions by creating a shared process through which faculty and tutoring staff identify recurring student needs, recommend resources, review explanations, and communicate differences in instructional methods. Instructor-specific options could preserve important teaching differences without fragmenting the overall system.

This is a secondary alignment rather than the project's central purpose. The Hub may encourage collaboration and instructional innovation, but it is not itself a comprehensive employee-development or succession-planning program.

Alignment With Broader Strategic Themes

- **Removing barriers:** The Hub addresses the difficulty students face when they do not know what skill is missing, what the skill is called, or which outside explanation matches their course.
- **Connecting instruction and support:** The project links faculty instruction, D2L resources, interactive applications, and tutoring rather than treating each as an isolated service.
- **Using scale intentionally:** A shared collection can make effective resources available across College Algebra sections while still allowing selected instructor-specific alternatives.
- **Testing before expanding:** The proposed phased approach begins with an inventory, prioritization, and initial build, then uses classroom evidence and feedback to decide what should be revised or developed next.
- **Supporting access through technology:** D2L provides a consistent institutional home, while the Math Portal could extend selected interactive resources to phones, tablets, and computers.

Outcomes the Project Could Demonstrate

The most defensible early outcomes are those directly connected to the Hub's design and use. Broader institutional outcomes should be described as possible contributions until the project has sufficient implementation data.

Outcome area	Possible evidence	Interpretation
Access and use	Visits, starts, completions, repeat use, and referral source	Shows whether students can find and use the support
Learning process	Correct responses, common errors, help use, and recovery after feedback	Shows where students struggle and whether guided support assists them
Student experience	Reported clarity, confidence, usefulness, and open-ended feedback	Shows how students experience the resources and what needs revision
Instructional improvement	Changes made after evidence and results following revision	Shows whether the Hub is improving through intentional evaluation
Course and pathway outcomes	Course completion, subsequent course progress, or transfer-related indicators	Potential longer-term contribution requiring careful comparison and sufficient data

Conclusion

The College Algebra Skills Hub should be presented primarily as a G2 Academic Excellence project. It directly combines instruction with academic support and creates a structured way to help students address preparation gaps without lowering expectations. Its contribution to G4 is credible through gateway-course success and transfer preparation, and its collaborative model offers secondary support for G3. The strongest strategic case is therefore focused rather than universal: the Hub advances academic excellence, removes barriers to learning, and builds a more connected path between classroom instruction and student support.

Source: Lone Star College System Strategic Plan 2025 to 2030, final October 2025.